



Backend Developer Equity Partnership Proposal

Early-Stage Team & Equity Framework

PREPARED BY

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STATUS

Proposed Framework — For Discussion

DATE

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01 INTRODUCTION

DOVA is an early-stage startup currently developing its Minimum Viable Product (MVP). As a bootstrapped company, DOVA is building a committed early team through a combination of limited cash resources and equity participation, ensuring that those who help shape the technology in this critical early phase share meaningfully in the company's future success.

This proposal is prepared specifically for the **Backend Developer** and is intended to clearly establish their role, contribution, equity, expectations, and potential future compensation as a member of DOVA's founding technical team.

02 ROLE & RESPONSIBILITIES

- Design and develop DOVA's backend systems.
- Build and maintain APIs and server-side functionality.
- Develop authentication and user-management systems.
- Support database architecture and data management.
- Integrate required payment, notification, and third-party services.
- Implement appropriate security and access controls.
- Work closely with the frontend developer and QA tester.
- Support MVP deployment and technical maintenance.
- Contribute to future backend improvements as DOVA grows.

03 EQUITY ARRANGEMENT

3%

PROPOSED EQUITY

Offered in recognition of the Backend Developer's early contribution to building DOVA's technology, and to encourage long-term commitment to the company.

This 3% is **not granted immediately in full**. It is earned over time through an agreed vesting and milestone structure, as outlined below.

Total Equity	3%
Vesting Period	4 years
Cliff	1 year
Vesting Schedule	Monthly, following the cliff
Milestones	Completion and continued maintenance of agreed backend responsibilities
Conditions	Equity remains subject to continued contribution and the final written agreement

If the Backend Developer stops contributing before their equity has vested, the unvested portion will not be earned, subject to the terms of the final legal agreement.

04 CASH COMPENSATION AFTER FUNDING

DOVA is currently bootstrapped and operating with limited resources. If DOVA secures external investment, the company intends to establish appropriate cash compensation for continuing team members — including the Backend Developer — based on the company's available funding, role, responsibilities, and mutually agreed terms.

No specific salary is promised at this stage.

05 INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

Backend code, APIs, database structures, documentation, server configurations, and other technology created specifically for DOVA as part of this engagement will be assigned to DOVA under the terms of the final written agreement.

06 COMMITMENT & EXPECTATIONS

- Professionalism
- Reliability
- Confidentiality
- Timely completion of agreed tasks
- Collaboration with the frontend developer and QA tester
- Proper documentation
- Security-conscious development
- Continued support during MVP launch

07 FUTURE GROWTH

As DOVA grows and secures funding, the Backend Developer may have opportunities for increased responsibility, compensation, and leadership within the technical team, subject to future agreements.

08 LEGAL DISCLAIMER

"This document represents a proposed framework for discussion and does not constitute a final legal agreement. The final equity percentage, vesting schedule, milestones, intellectual-property ownership, confidentiality obligations, termination provisions, and other terms will be formally documented in a legally binding agreement."

09 ACCEPTANCE

BACKEND DEVELOPER

Name

Signature

Date

FOUNDER — DOVA

Name

Egegieh Onyekachi Daniel

Signature

Date

DOVA

Building a better food supply network from Nigerian farmers to consumers.